



New customer request intake.

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE — CUSTOMER SUCCESS

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1. Purpose

This SOP defines how the Customer Success team responds to a new wholesale account request submitted through the DSS Distro storefront. It covers the first qualifying call, account creation in Shopify and ACT, and the handoff to the dedicated account manager. The goal is a consistent intake experience that confirms customer information, captures the data needed downstream, and sets the customer up for a smooth first order.

2. Scope

Applies to every new wholesale request that arrives in the DSS Info inbox with the subject line “New Customer Request.” Applies to the Customer Success representative on intake duty for that day and to the Customer Success Lead who supervises the rotation. Out of scope: existing-customer reorders, account-manager activity after the handoff, and credit or payment-terms decisions (handled separately by Finance).

3. Roles and responsibilities

ROLE	RESPONSIBILITY
Customer Success representative	Receives the intake email, makes the first call, qualifies the lead, creates the Shopify and ACT records, and either transfers the customer or schedules a follow-up.
Customer Success Lead	Owns the assignment rotation between account managers, audits new accounts weekly, and approves any deviation from this SOP.

Account Manager (Gab or Eric)	Takes over the account once intake is complete. Walks the customer through the catalogue, pricing, and product recommendations. Receives a warm transfer or a scheduled callback.
Finance	Validates provincial and federal tax numbers when flagged. Owns the indemnity-agreement archive.

4. Process trigger

A prospective wholesale customer submits the application form on the DSS Distro storefront. The form is reached from the storefront login page via the “Apply for a wholesale account” link.

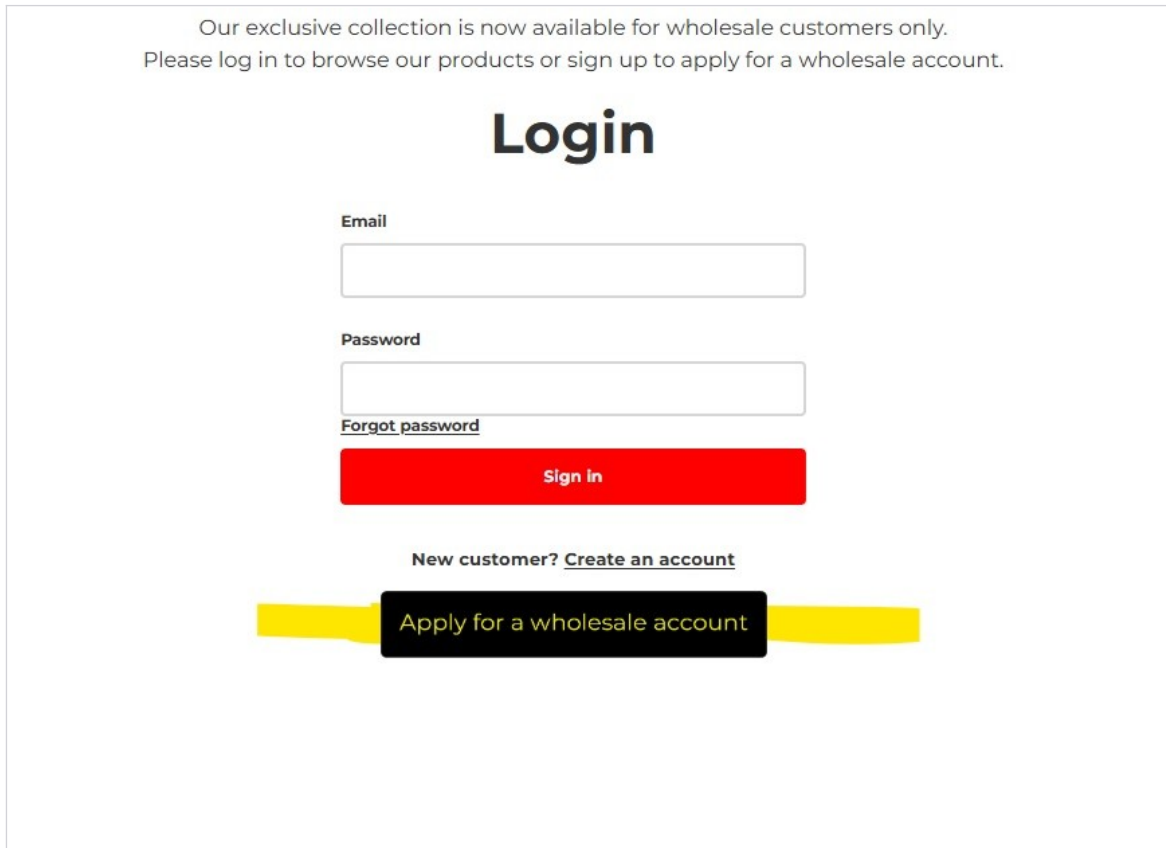


Figure 1 — Storefront login page; customers begin a wholesale request from the “Apply for a wholesale account” link.

The wholesale application asks the customer to provide the fields listed below. Fields marked with an asterisk are mandatory on the form, but a customer may still submit incomplete information — which is why the first call matters.

- Country code.
- Full name.
- Company name.
- Website (if available).
- Email address.

- Phone number.
- Provincial and/or federal tax number.
- Preferred brand name or store.
- Number of years in business.
- Shipping address.
- Billing address.

WHOLESALE APPLICATION

Name

Company Name

Website

Email

Phone

Provincial/Federal Tax Number

Referred by Name and Store

Figure 2 — Wholesale Application form on the DSS Distro storefront.

Once submitted, Shopify forwards the application to the DSS Info inbox as an email from “mailer@shopify.com” with the subject “New Customer Request.” The body contains every field the customer filled in. This email is the trigger event for this SOP.

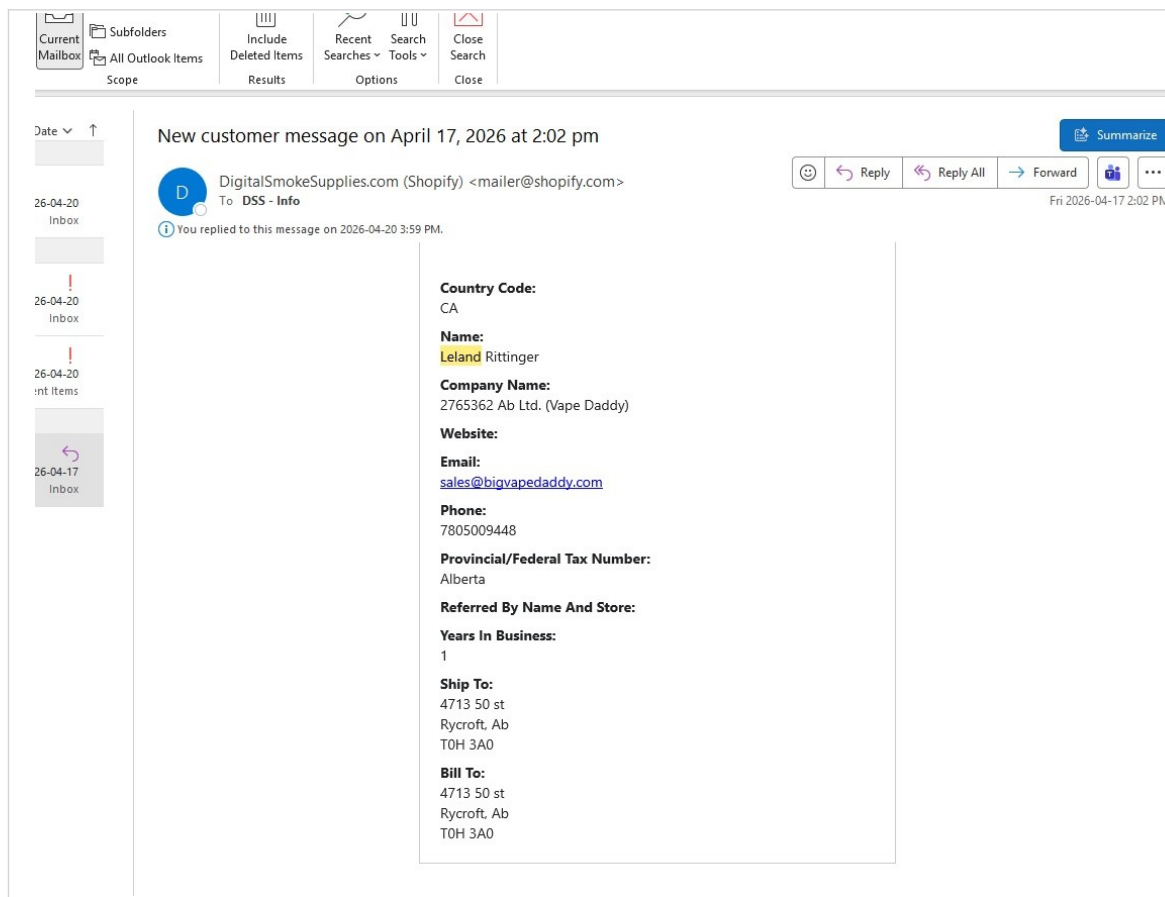


Figure 3 — “New Customer Request” email in the DSS Info inbox; trigger event for the intake process.

5. Pre-call preparation

Before placing the first call, the representative completes two checks.

1. Open the customer database template at **Public** → **Emna** → **Customer Database Template** on SharePoint and review the latest entries.
2. Check the last customer assignment to determine whose turn it is in the rotation between **Gab** and **Eric**. The rotation alternates strictly; do not skip a name without lead approval.

Have the original Shopify email open in a second window so the customer-supplied data is visible while the call is in progress.

6. First customer call

The first call has two objectives: confirm the information the customer submitted on the form, and build a conversation that surfaces details the form does not capture. Use a warm, professional tone throughout.

Introduction

“Hey, this is [your name] calling from Digital Smoke Supplies. I’m part of the Customer Success team. How are you doing today?”

Once the customer responds, explain the reason for the call.

"We received your request to open a wholesale account with us, and I personally like to welcome new customers with a quick call and ask a few questions, if you don't mind."

Qualifying questions

Work through the questions below. Confirm what the customer already provided and fill in anything missing. Take notes directly into the ACT record once it exists.

- How did you hear about us?
- Confirm the company name.
- Confirm how many years they have been in business.
- How many locations or stores do they have?
- Are they the owner or the store manager?
- Is the phone number provided the store number or a personal number?
- Do they have a website?
- Do they sell online?
- Are they looking for any specific brands or product categories?
- Is the email address provided the best email for orders and account communication?
- Ask for their provincial and federal tax numbers to verify the legitimacy of the business.
- Which provinces are they planning to sell in?

Handling product questions

If the customer asks for product recommendations, do not improvise. Defer to the dedicated account manager.

"That's actually a great question. Once your account is finalized, your dedicated account manager will contact you and walk you through our catalogue, pricing, and product recommendations tailored to your store."

7. Provincial considerations and the Indemnity Agreement

Some provinces require additional handling because of how excise stamps are applied. Ontario is the most common example.

If the customer is based in Ontario, ask whether they will purchase:

- Ontario-stamped products only, or
- Federally stamped products as well.

If the customer wants federally stamped products, the representative must send the Indemnity Agreement for Additional Duty Provinces before the federal tag is applied to the Shopify account. The agreement is located at:

- **Public → DSS Tools → Sales and Reporting → Indemnity Agreement for Additional Duty Provinces**

The agreement must be signed and returned before the Federal tag is added in Shopify. The agreement protects DSS Distro legally and confirms that the customer accepts responsibility for federally stamped

purchases. File the signed copy in the customer's ACT record under Documents and notify Finance that the agreement is on file.

8. Shopify account creation

Create the Shopify customer record immediately after the call. The Shopify customer ID is required before the ACT record can be linked, so do not skip ahead.

1. In Shopify, go to **Customers** and click **Add customer** in the top-right corner.

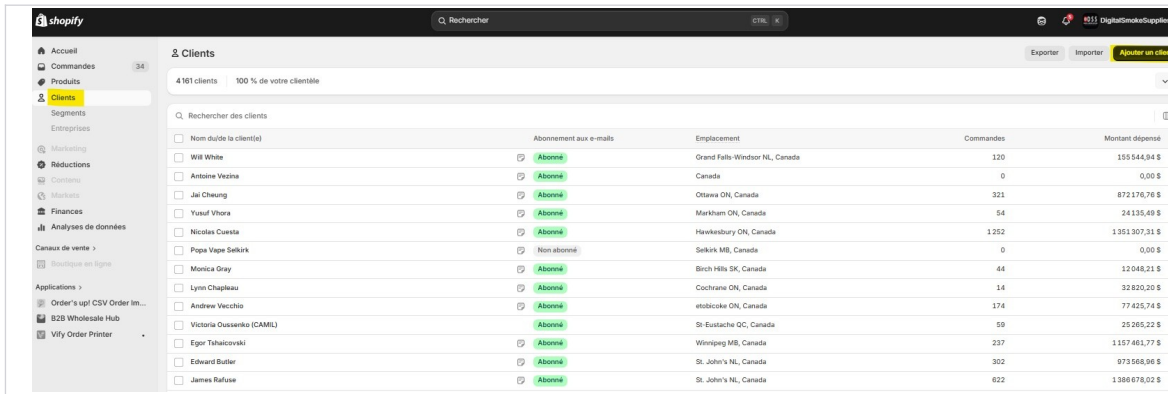
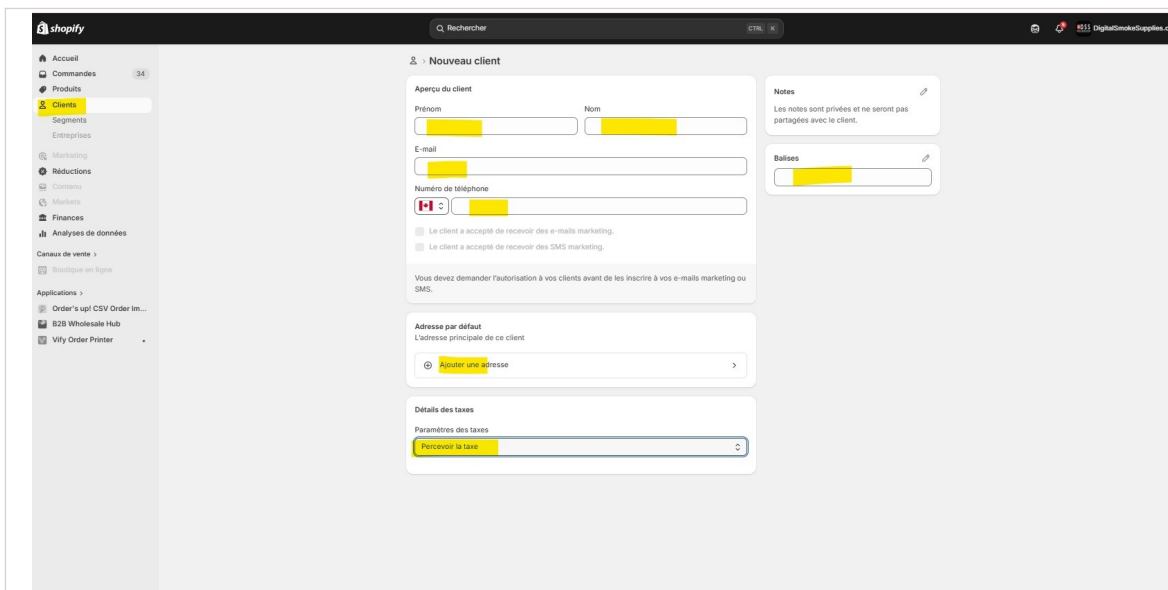


Figure 4 — Shopify Clients page; "Ajouter un client" highlighted in the top-right.

2. Fill in the customer overview: first name, last name, email, and phone number, using the country code from the application.
3. Add the default address. Enter both the shipping and billing addresses confirmed during the call.
4. Enter federal and provincial tax information under tax details. Set **Collect tax** so Shopify charges the correct tax on each order. (If the shop is on a Reserve, they do not pay taxes).
5. Apply tags. Every wholesale customer receives the tags below.



Nouveau client

Aperçu du client

Prénom Nom

E-mail

Numéro de téléphone

☒ Le client a accepté de recevoir des e-mails marketing.
☐ Le client a accepté de recevoir des SMS marketing.

Vous devez demander l'autorisation à vos clients avant de les inscrire à vos e-mails marketing ou SMS.

Adresse par défaut
 L'adresse principale de ce client

Détails des taxes
 Paramètres des taxes

Notes
 Les notes sont privées et ne seront pas partagées avec le client.

Balises

Figure 5 — Shopify "New Customer" form; populate the customer overview, default address, tags, and tax details.

TAG	WHEN APPLIED
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Wholesale	Always. Marks the account as B2B.
Province tag	Always. Use the customer's province (Ontario, Alberta, Manitoba, etc.). One tag per account.
Gab or Eric	Always. Reflects the rotation assignment confirmed in pre-call preparation.
Federal	Only when the customer purchases federally stamped products and the signed Indemnity Agreement is on file.

Save the record. Shopify generates an activation email automatically and sends it to the customer's confirmed email address. The customer must click the activation link before they can log in.

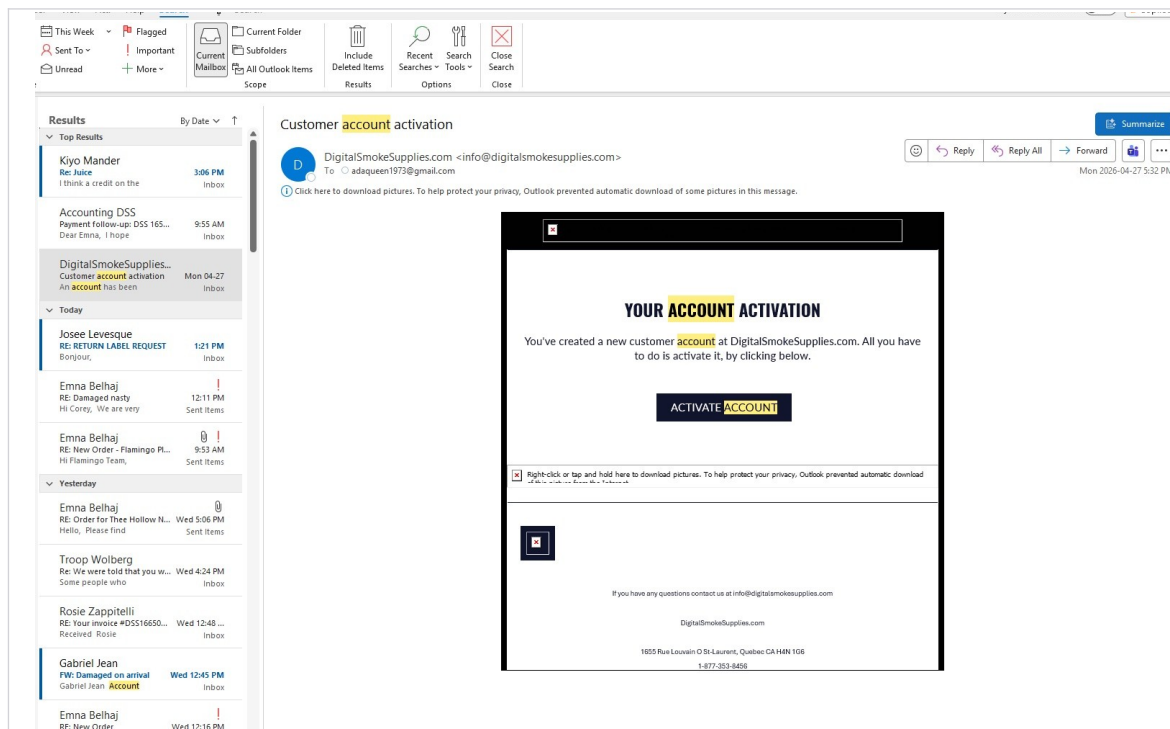


Figure 6 — “Customer account activation” email the customer receives after the Shopify record is saved.

9. ACT account creation

ACT is the system of record for customer relationships. Every new Shopify wholesale account has a matching ACT contact. Create it the same day the Shopify record is created.

1. Open ACT and click **New**.
2. Fill in every field on the Business Card: account key, contact name, company, phone, email, web site, and address.
3. Paste the Shopify customer ID into the **Account Key** field. This is the link between the two systems and is required.
4. Set the contact owner to the assigned account manager (Gab or Eric).
5. Add a History entry summarizing the intake call: date, who you spoke with, and any notes from the qualifying questions.

10. Handoff and closing

The intake ends with one of three handoff outcomes. Choose in this order of preference.

Warm transfer

If the customer is still on the line and the assigned account manager is available, offer an immediate transfer.

“If you’re available, I can transfer you right away to your dedicated account manager.”

Scheduled follow-up

If the customer is on the line but the account manager is not available, schedule a follow-up call directly in ACT under the account manager’s name. Use Schedule Activity → Call, set the date and time, and add the regarding line so the account manager has context.

If the customer was not available to take the original call, schedule a follow-up call for the next business day in ACT under Gab or Eric, depending on the rotation assignment.

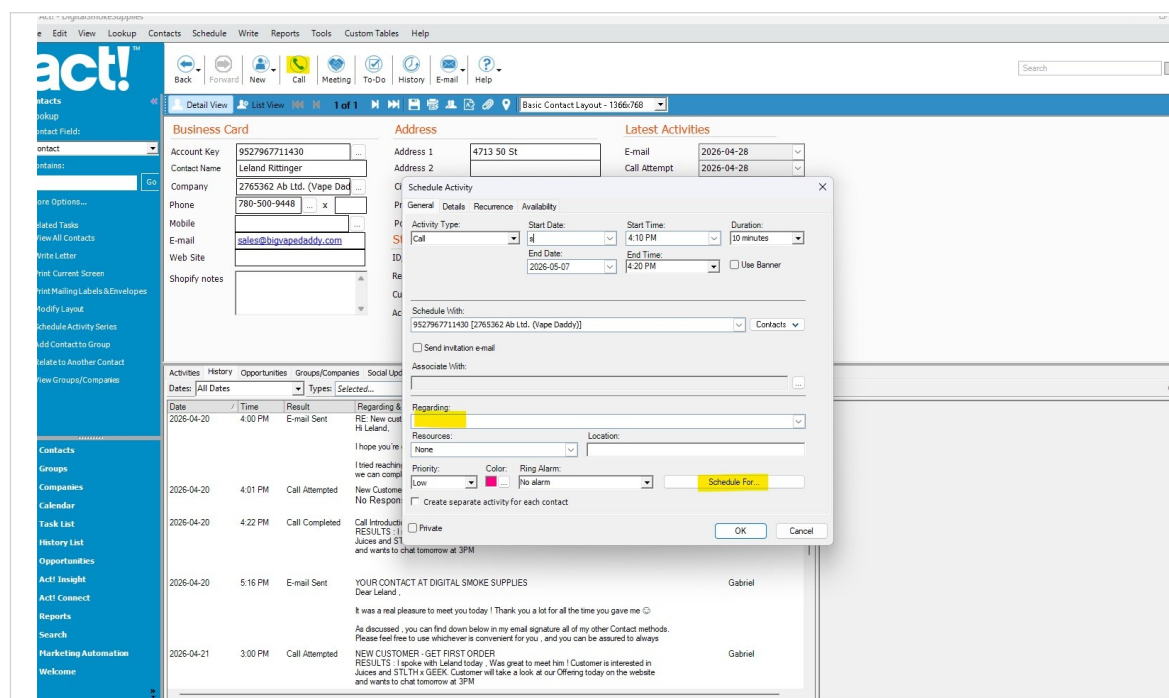


Figure 7 — ACT! Schedule Activity dialog; book the next-day call against the assigned account manager.

Closing the call

Before ending the call, confirm three things with the customer.

- DSS Distro is excited to work with them.
- Their account setup is in progress.
- Their dedicated account manager will follow up shortly.

After the call, send the customer the **standard payment options email** from the Customer Success shared mailbox. This step is mandatory — the customer cannot place a first order without it.

Non-Compliance

Skipping the first call results in incomplete account data and downstream order errors. The Customer Success Lead audits new accounts weekly. Accounts with missing required fields, no ACT record, or no logged intake call are reassigned and the responsible representative is coached at the next one-on-one.

Applying the Federal tag in Shopify without a signed Indemnity Agreement on file is treated as a compliance breach. The account is frozen, the tag is removed, and the incident is reported to Finance and the Customer Success Lead within one business day. Repeat occurrences trigger a formal performance review.

Exceptions

Deviations from this SOP require written approval from the Customer Success Lead before the account is created. Common approved grounds:

- Existing customer of an affiliated brand who is migrating to DSS Distro and has already provided verified tax documents.
- Account manager assignment override (skipping the rotation) when one of Gab or Eric is on leave or already managing a related store.
- Same-day Federal tag application when the Indemnity Agreement has been signed digitally and Finance has confirmed receipt.

Approved exceptions are recorded in the customer's ACT History with the approver's name and the reason. No verbal-only exceptions.